Australian Government
Civil Aviation Safety Authority

2025 CASA Update

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2025 Update

1. GA Workplan – 2025 Update
2. 5G Radio Altimeters – MOS changes – Equipment requirements
3. ADS-B – Equipment rebate - 2nd round – ADS-B White Paper mandate
4. CASA Defect reporting
5. Part 43 and Modular Licencing – Update
6. MITCOM/FITCOM

General Aviation (GA) Workplan 2025

CASA published a refreshed GA Workplan (mid-2025) which builds on the 2022 plan.

- Part 43 maintenance framework – CASA is working on streamlining maintenance regulations to simplify compliance for GA operators and licensed maintainers.
- Airworthiness Directive (AD) review – CASA is reviewing Australia-unique ADs to align with international practice, which could reduce the local burden on maintenance organisations.
  - Collate inconsistencies between Australian ADs and SoD AD requirements.
  - Potential changes in consultation with industry to determine which ADs could be streamlined (i.e. changed or possibly cancelled) without compromising safety.
  - Proposed end-date of Q4 2026.

General Aviation (GA) Workplan 2025

- Continuous improvement in regulatory service delivery
- CASA is aiming to improve the timeliness and transparency of approvals, certificates, and variation processes.
- Digitalisation of services: CASA is upgrading its online portals (myCASA, permissions systems) so applications for licences, medicals, maintenance approvals, and authorisations can be tracked and processed more efficiently.

General Aviation (GA) Workplan 2025

- Regulatory reform changes will include the implementation of the Part 103 MOS for Sport and Recreational aircraft.
  - Consult with relevant stakeholders during 2025 and 2026
  - Finalise the Part 103 Manual of Standards (MOS) in 2026.
- MOSAIC – Modernization of Special Airworthiness Certificates (MOSAIC),
  - Review FAA implementation and assess for the Australian environment,
  - Develop policies and work with stakeholders to implement them.

General Aviation (GA) Workplan 2025

- Recognition of military qualifications (Q3 2026).
- Enhance maintenance licence pathways (Q4 2026).
- Air transport and continuing airworthiness - Part 42 and Part 145 (Q4 2028).

5G / Radio Altimeter (RA)

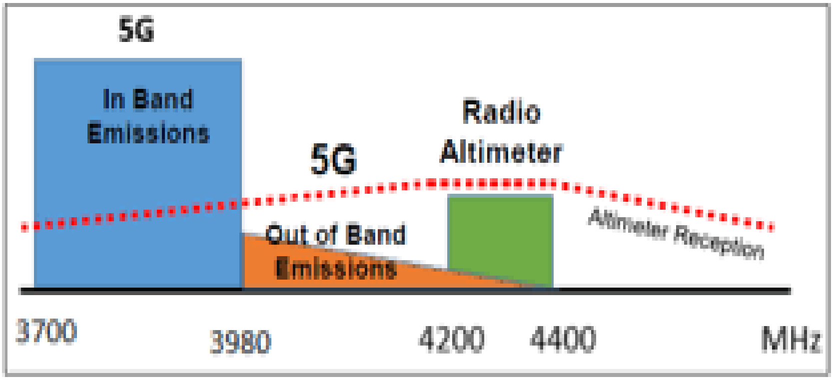
Frequency overlap risk: 5G services in the 3.7–4.0 GHz band are close to the 4.2–4.4 GHz band used by aircraft RAs, creating potential interference.

Safety concern: Interference can cause incorrect altitude readings, which are critical during landing approaches, terrain avoidance, and automated flight systems. Integration is wide and varied.

Operational restrictions: To protect aircraft, temporary limits were placed on 5G tower power levels and locations near airports.

Equipment vulnerability: Older or non-upgraded RA systems are more susceptible to 5G interference compared to newer, tolerant models.

Regulatory response: CASA will require operators to upgrade/replace non-compliant RAs by 2026, after which protective 5G restrictions near airports will be lifted.



Spectrum

5G / Radio Altimeter (RA) and MOS Changes

- **What's Changing:** CASA will amend the relevant MOSs to require that any aircraft conducting the following instrument approach procedures comply with the "radio altimeter tolerant airplane" criteria specified in FAA AD 2023-10-07.

- **Why:** In light of the complexity of developing new minimum standards, the time needed to design, test, and manufacture new RA systems, and the withdrawal of existing mitigations the FAA AD gives the best protection for most systems already in use.

  - FAA AD 2023-10-02 (fixed wing) and 2023-11-07 (rotorcraft).
  - Non-compliant RAs must be upgraded or replaced.
  - CASA remains in consultation with ACMA (Australian Communications and Media Authority).

- **Impacts:** Operators must upgrade/replace by 31 March 2026*. Non-compliant aircraft cannot fly certain approaches post-deadline. Not a requirement if approaches are not flown.

5G / Radio Altimeter (RA) MOS Changes

MOS Amendments (CD 2513AS) – Consultation closed

- **What's Changing:** CASA consulted on MOS amendments across Parts 91, 121, 133, and 135 to formalise RA requirements, codifying performance thresholds and interference tolerance.

Received feedback from both domestic and international operators.

CASA references - **5G and aviation safety** and AWB 34-020 Issue 9.

Automatic Dependent Surveillance Broadcast (ADS-B) Rebate Program – Round 2

www.business.gov.au

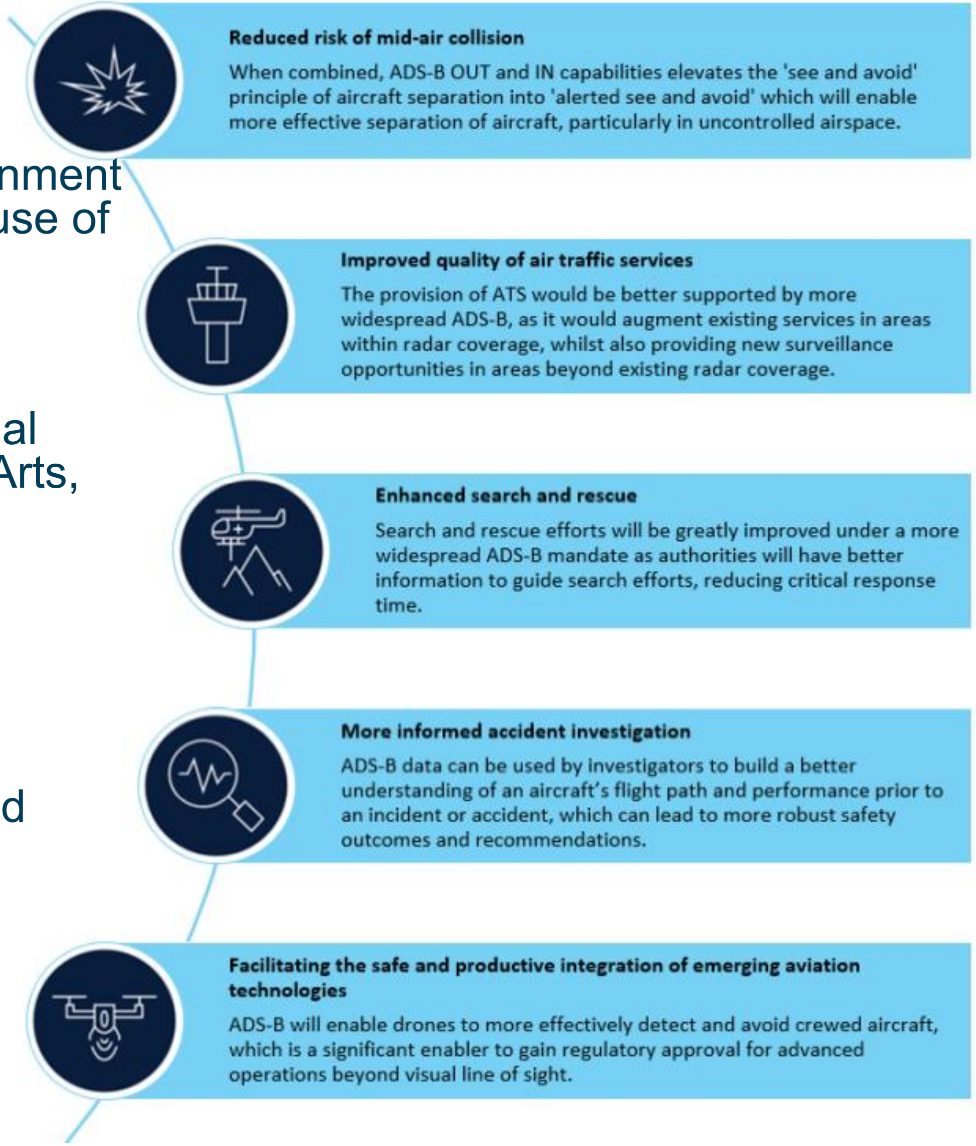
Change Area	Round 1	Round 2
Eligibility	Primarily VFR aircraft; EC devices and ADS-B OUT only	Expanded to include IFR aircraft and ADS-B IN functionality
Duration / Funding	Closed 31 May 2024 (or earlier if funds exhausted)	Runs until 31 May 2027, AUD 8.4m budget over 3 years
Eligible Devices	ADS-B OUT, EC devices for VFR	ADS-B IN, ADS-B IN+OUT, EC (portable or installed)
Date Thresholds	Purchase/install after program start; Round 1 rules applied	ADS-B OUT/EC: after 20 Dec 2021; ADS-B IN/IN+OUT: after 1 June 2024
Repeat Applications	Generally not allowed for aircraft that received Round 1 rebate	Allowed if upgrading (e.g., EC → installed, or adding ADS-B IN)
Who Can Apply	VFR operators, aircraft owners, recreational aviation orgs	VFR + IFR aircraft owners; recreational aviation orgs
Grant Value	50% of costs, cap AUD 5,000 per aircraft	Same (50%, cap AUD 5,000); expanded eligible expenditure definitions

ADS-B - Expansion

In the [2024 Aviation White Paper](), the Australian Government committed to consider expanding the mandate for the use of ADS-B in Australia.

ADS-B Mandate Cross Agency Working Group

- Department of Infrastructure, Transport, Regional Development, Communications, Sport and the Arts,
- CASA,
- Airservices Australia,
- Australian Transport Safety Bureau (ATSB),
- Australian Maritime Safety Authority (AMSA) and
- Department of Defence (Defence)



ADS-B – VFR and IFR Aircraft

- A staged introduction of ADS-B OUT capability for all aircraft operating under VFR, including the use of approved electronic conspicuity (EC) device in some circumstances.
- The model would see aircraft operating under VFR in class A, D, E and G airspace equipped with ADS-B OUT from 2028.
- A transition to approved ADS-B (OUT/IN) equipment for all capable VFR aircraft in all airspace is envisaged in the long term, beyond 2033.
- IFR Aircraft - Already required to use ADS-B OUT, the proposal is to mandate the use of ADS-B IN for all capable aircraft in all airspace from 2033.

ADS-B – Drones and Advanced Air Mobility (AAM)

- Future-proof an ADS-B mandate for drones.
- The working group also proposes all small drones operating above 400 feet above ground level (AGL), along with all medium and large drones have ADS-B OUT capability from the end of 2028.
- Proposed ADS-B IN capability from the end of 2028 for all beyond visual line of sight (BVLOS) drone operations, either by way of onboard equipment or a ground-based ADS-B receiver.
- Advanced air mobility (AAM) - all AAM aircraft to be fitted with both ADS-B OUT and ADS-B IN capability from the end of 2028.

ADS-B – Advisory Information

CASA updated AC 91-23 v2.0 (“ADS-B for Enhancing Situational Awareness”) in July 2025,

- giving pilots and operators updated guidance on choosing ADS-B/Transponders, usage, configuration, etc.

AirServices provides “Flight Operations Information Packages,”

- ADS-B coverage maps, operational guidance, and supports pilots/operators in understanding surveillance coverage limits.

ADS-B - Consultation

Part A - is an executive summary which outlines the considerations and benefits of an expanded ADS-B mandate, culminating in the proposed model.

Part B - summarises in further detail what ADS-B is, how it works, and how it's been regulated in Australia to date.

Views on the potential model and alternatives for an ADS-B mandate are presented in the paper.

Consultation closes 27 October 2025. For more information and to make a submission visit the Department of Infrastructure website - Have your say page.

Defect Reporting – Other than ‘major’ defects

- CAR (Reg 51A): Major defects must be reported to CASA immediately.
- Other defects (CAR 51, 51B and 52)
- CASR: (Part/Division 42.): Major defects must be reported within 2 days of discovery.
- AD/CASA direction compliance: Safety-related defects outside the directive must be reported within 2 working days.
- For aircraft covered by Approved Self-Administering Organisations (ASAOs), refer to the Defect Reporting procedures of the relevant organisation.

Defect Reporting – Other than ‘major’ defects

Enhances safety: Spot early warning signs, track trends, and prevent escalation into major failures.

Supports the aviation community: Contributes to fleet-wide data, helps detect systemic or design issues early.

Builds safety culture: Shows proactive management, encourages reporting, strengthens trust and reputation.

Improves maintenance & reliability: Informs reliability programs, aids planning, reduces downtime.

Assists manufacturers & regulators: Can trigger service bulletins, drive design improvements, and inform CASA guidance/ADs.

Defect Reporting – Other than 'major' defects

Tail rotor – All AW139 current pedal issue.

Pitot/static – No real uptick in occurrences related to a specific issue.

1 x unrelated,

2 x reports of pitot cover/metal contamination,

1 x moth parts in pitot whilst in hangar (From operator - insufficient information to determine origin of insect. Likely struck on landing before pitot covers were put on),

1 x updated report of previous report (no new data),

1 x BNE suspected mud wasp contamination (A320.

Wheels –

6 x reports S340B wheel cracks,

3 x A320 MWA tie bolt failures (4 reports in DRS from this year all on #3 MWA).

Monthly Ave Previous Period, Monthly Ave Current Period, Change in Average, %Change in Average, Defects Reported Pr...

BY PART JASC CODE LEVEL 2

Part JASC Code Level 2	Defects Reported Current Period	Defects Reported Previous Period	Monthly Ave Current Period	Monthly Ave Previous Period	Change in Average	%Change in Average
6720 TAIL ROTOR CONTROL SYSTEM	17	2	4.25	0.17	4.08	2450%
3411 PITOT/STATIC SYSTEM	6	4	1.50	0.33	1.17	350%
3246 WHEEL/SKI/FLOAT	9	14	2.25	1.17	1.08	93%
8520 RECIPROCATING ENGINE POWER SECTION	5	29	1.25	2.42	-1.17	-48%
3230 LANDING GEAR RETRACT/EXTENSION SYSTEM	6	38	1.50	3.17	-1.67	-53%
6210 MAIN ROTOR BLADES	2	18	0.50	1.50	-1.00	-67%
2730 ELEVATOR CONTROL SYSTEM	1	17	0.25	1.42	-1.17	-82%

Part 43 - Update

CASA Part 43 — Overview & Recent Developments

What is Part 43 (CASR)?

Part 43 is a new proposed regulatory framework under the Civil Aviation Safety Regulations (CASR) for **maintenance of aircraft used in private and aerial work operations** (general aviation) in Australia.

It is designed to be optional for eligible operators, offering a new pathway to reduce regulatory burden while maintaining safety.

Part 43 will *not* affect maintenance rules for aircraft used in scheduled or non-scheduled air transport operations (i.e. operations under CASR Parts 121, 133, 135).

Part 43 - Update

Part 43 – Update - Basis

- The new Part 43 is largely modelled on U.S. FAA maintenance rules (FAR Part 43), with adjustments for Australia.
- The US-FARs were chosen for their well-established nature, clear requirements, and scalability, offering a modern and simplified approach to maintenance regulation for the general aviation sector.
- 78% of respondents preferred the FAR model (CASA Consultation).

Part 43 – Update – Who it effects

- GA aircraft in private & aerial work ops (e.g. mustering, survey, non-transport training).
- Maintenance personnel: LAMEs, IA holders, new Aircraft Maintenance Technician Certificate (AMTC) certificate holders.
- Pilots (with RO authorisation) for limited preventive/pilot maintenance.
- Registered Operators (ROs): choose to opt in.

Part 43 – Update - LAME (B2) Privileges

LAME (B2) Privileges under Part 43

- Core scope: B2s may perform and certify avionics/electrical maintenance and approve return to service (within MOS limits).
- Routine Avionics Maintenance – B2s can maintain and certify avionics/electrical systems without needing a Part 145 organisation (within MOS limits).
- Inspection Role – Can complete and certify avionics/electrical parts of annual or 100-hr inspections; B1/IA holder relies on their sign-off.

Part 43 – Update - Extended B2 Privileges (Proposed)

- Avionics IA – With a new Avionics IA, B2s may certify major avionics repairs/mods if they don’t affect structure, engines, or mechanical systems.
- Certification & Return to Service – B2s may sign off work they perform; full return-to-service may still need a B1 IA if higher-risk systems are affected.
- Task-by-Task Expansion – Privileges can be extended with training, supervision, or proven competence.
  - Task-by-task expansion means CASA will allow B2 LAMEs to take on extra avionics tasks outside their standard licence privileges.

Part 43 – Update - Proposed Changes (Last ~2 Years)

Inspection Authorisations (IA)

- Extended the renewal period from 2 years to 5 years and simplified the renewal requirements.
- Industry pushed for 5-year renewals.

Impact Analysis Update

- The Office of Impact Analysis published a regulatory impact analysis (RIA / “Impact Analysis”) for the proposed Part 43, comparing “status quo vs new Part 43” options.
- The Impact Analysis reaffirmed CASA’s intention to adopt many U.S. FAR-based rules (with minimal amendments) and to reduce regulatory burdens for the GA / aerial work sectors.

Part 43 – Update – TWG

MOS amendments & refinements - The 7th TWG meeting (July 2024) reviewed and amended portions of the Part 43 MOS, especially to align with the original policy intent and ensure restrictions on IA privileges are clear.

In the 8th TWG meeting (Aug 2024), CASA and TWG focused on producing the Plain English Guide, ACs, IA Handbook, training programs, and transitional rules. Civil Aviation Safety Authority

Preparing material needed for smoother implementation and industry uptake.

Part 43 – Update - Proposed Changes (Last ~2 Years)

Transitional rules & interaction with existing frameworks TWG also discussed transition arrangements to allow Part 145 / CAR 30 organisations to continue operating alongside Part 43 in a hybrid environment.

CASA Clarifies Part 43 Will Be Optional

- In mid-2024, Executive Manager Stakeholder Engagement confirmed that Part 43 will **not** be mandatory, but rather an optional pathway for GA / aerial work operators.
- This aligns with the proposed rules, which continue to allow existing regimes (CAR 30 / Part 145) for operators who prefer not to adopt Part 43.

Part 43 – Update - Proposed Changes (Last ~2 Years)

Policy Adjustments & Conditional Limits Introduced

- The draft rule includes explicit limits: for example, maintenance of transport-category aircraft and turbine engines is still constrained to approved organisations under Part 43.
- CASA has clarified that maintenance organisation approvals are still required for repairs to instruments, major repairs/mods to propellers, overhaul of turbine engines, and specified maintenance of transport-category aircraft.

Part 43 – Update – What happens now

1. Ministerial consideration & decision

The Minister (for Infrastructure / Transport) reviews the regulatory package and must decide whether to approve, modify, or reject the proposal.

If approved, the rules and MOS move toward formalisation, making the delegated legislation.

Part 43 – Update – What happens now

2. Drafting of regulation instruments & execution

CASA / government lawyers prepare the final versions of the regulations, Manual of Standards (MOS), and any legislative instruments (exemptions, transitional rules).

The final instruments are tabled in Parliament, potentially subject to disallowance.

Parliamentary oversight & disallowance period

Once tabled, the regulation is typically open to parliamentary scrutiny and potentially disallowed under the Legislation Act.

If not disallowed, it becomes law.

Part 43 – Update – What happens now

3. Publication & implementation timeline

CASA announces the commencement date (when Part 43 becomes active).

A transition period is usually provided — existing CAR 30 / Part 145 operators may shift to the new system over time.

4. Support materials & guidance rollout

CASA will release guidance, training, advisory circulars, Plain English Guides, and support tools to help industry understand and comply with the new rules.

Acting through the Part 43 Technical Working Group (TWG) to finalise implementation details.

Part 43 – Update – What happens now

5. Monitoring, review & feedback

Once in force, CASA will monitor compliance, safety outcomes, industry feedback.

Revisions or adjustments may follow based on real-world application.

Part 43 – Update - Questions

Modular Licencing

Modular Licensing

What is Modular Licensing (CASA)

Modular licensing lets you obtain a Part 66 licence with “exclusions” — i.e. limitations on which systems you can certify until you gain more training/experience.

Over time, exclusions can be removed by passing additional modules or gaining more practical experience.

The modular pathway is designed for flexibility: It can be used to specialise in certain systems, expand gradually, and don’t necessarily have to go for a full licence immediately.

Modular Licensing

In September–October 2023, CASA opened consultation on amendments to the Part 66 Manual of Standards (MOS) to enable modular licensing for aircraft engineers.

Draft Information Sheet

CASA published a draft info sheet explaining how the modular licence proposal could work in practice (e.g. getting a licence sooner, adding privileges later). (see Consultation package)

Modular Licensing – B2

B2 Stream (Avionics / Electrical) — Structure & Privileges

Modular Options for B2

Under modular licensing, the B2 stream is subdivided into three modular categories: (Unless a licence is specifically subject to a mechanical or structural systems exclusion

- B2 – Electrical Systems only
- B2 – Instrument Systems only
- B2 – Radio Systems only

Licensees can expand from one modular category to the full B2 (E + I + R) by adding privileges over time.

Modular Licensing – B2 - Path

Where and how you can gain your licence

Part 147 MTO

Undertake formal training and practical assessment.

Part 66 theory exams applicable to B2 electrical systems.

Submit application to CASA for initial issue of licence.

Part 66 self-study (using Part 66 textbooks)

Self-study the relevant Part 66 basic knowledge modules – (Part 2A of Appendix I, of 66 MOS).

Undertake the exams through our contracted exam provider, applicable to B2 systems.

Complete the relevant sections of the practical experience logbook. Submit with application to CASA to issue an initial licence.

Modular Licensing – B2

B2 Modular Licence Pathway (CASA)

- Start in any stream — Electrical, Instrument, or Radio.
- Each stream requires completing the relevant Part 66 theory modules and documented logbook experience.
- CASA issues a modular licence with exclusions (only licensed for that stream).
- Add the other streams (E + I + R) by finishing their modules and logbook tasks, CASA removes exclusions.
- When all three are complete (and fulfilling all both exam and practical experience requirements) a full B2 licence (non-type rated) can be achieved.
- Type ratings can be added later through additional aircraft-specific training and experience.

Modular Licensing – B2

B2 basic knowledge — subject module requirements

- Successfully complete 10 examinations plus applicable (but not all) topics from module 13 (aircraft structures and systems).

Table 2: B2 modular licence examination requirements

Subject modules	B2 electrical systems only	B2 instrument systems only	B2 radio systems only
1. Mathematics	Yes	Yes	Yes
2. Physics	Yes	Yes	Yes
3. Electrical fundamentals	Yes	Yes	Yes
4. Electronic fundamentals	Yes	Yes	Yes

Modular Licensing – Update - 2024

Proposed modular licensing framework for aircraft maintenance engineers – Updated Part 66 MOS – Following consultation – 2024

- **Shorter exam “stand-down” periods**

What changed: After a failed Part 66 module exam the waiting times are reduced to: 1st fail → no stand-down; 2nd → 30 days; 3rd → 6 months (then cycle resets).

Why it matters: Speeds progression toward a licence while still pacing repeat attempts. These timings are now reflected on CASA’s exam page.

Modular Licensing – Update

- **UoC table moved into the MOS (Appendix X)**

What changed: The Units-of-Competency (VET UoCs) required for each modular licence category are being relocated from AMC/GM into a new Appendix of the Part 66 MOS, i.e., into the legislative instrument itself.

Why it matters: Puts the training/competency map on a firmer legal footing (MOS), reduces ambiguity about which UoCs apply, and makes provider/applicant obligations clearer in one place.

Modular Licensing – Update

- **Repeal of legacy pathways (CAR 31 / CASA Basics / SOE equivalence)**

What changed: CASA proposes removing MOS provisions that let applicants use older pathways (CAR 31, CASA Basics, Schedule-of-Experience equivalence) to obtain Part 66-equivalent outcomes.

Why it matters: Consolidates licensing around the current Part 66 modular framework and today’s competency model (UoCs + exams + logged experience). (Existing licence holders remain licensed; this change affects new/alternate pathway applicants.)